

Karen Zheng

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EDUCATION

New York University, Tisch School of the Arts | GPA: 3.8 | New York, NY Expected May 2028
BFA in Interactive Media Arts

RELEVANT EXPERIENCE

DuCode Studio | *UX Research Internship* | New York, NY June 2026 – Present

- Conduct competitive research on financial technology products and digital banking platforms.
- Present research findings and recommendations to support product planning and feature development.
- Analyzed user interview data by tagging transcripts with thematic codes.

Urban Arts, Game Academy | *Ambassador* | New York, NY Sep 2025 – Present

- Presented to 100+ students using user-focused communication and audience-tailored messaging
- Collaborated with 20+ team members to improve engagement and program experience consistency

Urban Arts, Game Academy | *Teacher Assistant* | New York, NY Sep 2024 – Present

- Taught 155+ students game design, interaction logic, and C# in Unity
- Supported curriculum iteration using feedback and data insights, increasing retention by 21%
- Designed structured learning experiences, achieving 98% completion rate (+37% YoY)

EGD Collective, Studio Aspen | *Prop Artist* | New York, NY Sep 2025 – Dec 2025

- Created iterative prop and environment designs in an 80+ member interdisciplinary studio
- Refined assets through critique cycles aligned with product-style design workflows
- Delivered production-ready visuals for 3D implementation

PROJECTS

Future Innovators Summit (Hosted by Comcast NBCUniversal) | *Google Slides, Procreate* Nov 2025

- Worked in a 5-person team in a 150+ participant design sprint to improve user experience
- Designed a wayfinding system featuring real-time wait times and exploration flows for Universal Epic Universe

Color Clash | *p5.js, Aseprite, After Effects* Nov 2024 – Dec 2024

- Designed interactive user flows and wireframes for a browser-based application, focusing on usability and clarity across multiple screens
- Built a component-based UI system with real-time input handling and state-based interactions
- Tested and iterated interface design to achieve smooth 60 FPS performance (90%+ speech recognition)

The Vanishing Enigma | *Unity, Visual Studio, C#, Aseprite* Aug 2023 – June 2024

- Contributed to 10-person game with 400+ players and 600+ views on itch.io
- Designed 15+ character assets supporting end-to-end game development
- Winner of 2024 Congressional App Challenge (12,682 submissions)

LEADERSHIP AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

Management Leadership for Tomorrow | *Career Preparation Fellow* | New York, NY Sep 2025 – Present

- Selected for an 18-month competitive leadership program focused on analytical thinking, structured problem solving, and professional development
- Complete business case studies and assignments to grow leadership and technical skills
- Attend conferences hosted by industry leaders such as Deloitte, LinkedIn, and Target

SKILLS

Coding: C#, Python, JavaScript, p5.js, Java, HTML, CSS

Design & Tools: Figma, Unity, Adobe Creative Suite, Aseprite, Visual Studio, Google Suite, Adobe After Effects

Certifications: EA Product Management Simulation (Forage), IBM AI & AI Interaction (SkillsBuild)